PhotoMatrix

Admin Guide

Importing Photos from a URL

July 2026

This guide walks through the Import tab in the admin panel. It lets you pull photos from any public photographer portfolio page and add them to PhotoMatrix in four steps — without ever leaving the browser.

1. Opening the Import Tab

1. Sign in as an admin and navigate to Manage (/admin).
2. Select the Import tab in the top navigation row.

2. Step 1 — Enter a URL and Choose Storage Mode

Field	What to do
Portfolio URL	Paste the full URL of the photographer's portfolio or gallery page (e.g. https://janedoe.photography/gallery).
Storage mode	Choose how images are stored (see below).

Storage modes

Download & store (recommended)
The server downloads each selected image and saves it in PhotoMatrix's own object storage. Photos remain available even if the original website changes or disappears.

Link only
Records are created that point back to the original image URL. No storage is used, but photos will break if the source removes them.

Click Scan for Photos when ready. The server fetches the page and extracts every <img> element. Large pages may take a few seconds.

> *Note: Password-protected pages, pages that require JavaScript rendering, or sites that block bots may not scan successfully. If the scan returns no photos, check that the URL is publicly accessible.*

3. Step 2 — Select Photos

After a successful scan, a thumbnail grid appears showing every image found on the page.

- Click a thumbnail (or its checkbox) to select / deselect it.
- Use Select All / Deselect All to toggle the whole set.
- The counter in the top-right shows how many photos are currently selected.
- The original alt text appears below each thumbnail as a preview of the title that will be used.

Click Next: Assign & Import to continue. You must select at least one photo.

4. Step 3 — Assign Photographer, Club, and Titles

This is where you tell PhotoMatrix who took the photos and optionally group them.

Photographer

Option	When to use
+ Add new photographer	The photographer does not yet exist in PhotoMatrix. Fill in their name and (optionally) a short bio — the bio is pre-filled from text the scanner found on the page; edit it as needed.
Select an existing name	The photographer already has a profile. Their photos will be added to their existing portfolio.

> *The Import button stays disabled until a photographer name is provided when "Add new" is selected.*

Club (Optional)

Leave this on None if the photos should not be linked to a club. Otherwise:
- Select an existing club from the list, or
- Choose + Add new club and type the club name.

Per-photo Title and Theme

Every selected photo appears in a scrollable list with two editable fields:

Field	Notes
Title	Required. The scanner pre-fills this from the image's alt text. Titles that look like camera filenames (e.g. IMG_20240315_123456.jpg, DSC_0042, PXL_20230901) are automatically cleared and shown with a red border — you must type a real title before importing.
Theme	Optional. Assign the photo to one of the site's themes. Defaults to "No theme".

You can scroll through the list and edit titles/themes before clicking Import. All red-bordered fields must be filled in — if you click Import with any title still empty, a toast message will tell you which photo needs a title.

Click *Import N photos* to start. A spinner shows progress; do not close the tab while importing.

5. Step 4 — Import Complete

A confirmation screen shows:

- How many photos were imported successfully.
- How many failed (network errors, unsupported formats, etc.).

Click Import More to return to Step 1 and start a new import session.

Photos that fail do not create partial records. You can safely re-scan the same URL and import only the failed ones.

6. Tips and Edge Cases

Photographer already exists but their name is slightly different

Choose their existing entry from the dropdown rather than creating a duplicate. You can always edit the photographer's name and bio later from the Photographers tab.

Some photos scanned but are showing as broken thumbnails

The proxy preview in Step 2 fetches images through the server to bypass CORS restrictions. A broken thumbnail usually means the source URL requires a session cookie or referrer header. Those photos will most likely fail to download — deselect them.

File-slug titles were cleared but the scanner found no `alt` text

This happens on sites that use filenames as alt attributes or that omit alt entirely. Simply type a descriptive title in the red field.

"Download & store" vs "Link only" — which to choose?

Use Download & store unless you are running a storage-constrained pilot or the photographer explicitly wants to keep photos on their own server. Link-only imports are fragile and can leave broken images in the gallery if the source disappears.

Importing the same photo twice

The import does not deduplicate by image URL. If you re-scan and re-import the same URL, you will create duplicate records. Always check whether the photos are already in the gallery before re-importing.

Last updated: July 2026